ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME — ENGLISH · CLASS 8 · SET 02

Max. Marks 60 · The Mastermind Coaching Classes, Jaipur · Any other correct answer in the student's own words to be accepted

SECTION A — READING (14 Marks) — 14 marks

Q1. Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow: **7**

The Dance of the Honeybee

When a honeybee finds a rich patch of flowers, it does not keep the secret to itself. It flies back to the hive and performs a special 'waggle dance' on the honeycomb. The bee moves in a straight line while shaking its body from side to side, then loops back and repeats the pattern. The angle of the straight run shows the direction of the flowers in relation to the sun, and the time the bee spends waggling tells its sisters how far they must fly.

Nearby bees touch the dancer with their antennae to learn the message. Within minutes, dozens of workers leave the hive and head straight for the flowers. Scientists who first decoded this language were amazed that a creature with a brain smaller than a sesame seed could share such exact information.

1. Where does the honeybee perform the waggle dance?

(a) On a flower (b) On the honeycomb
(c) On a tree trunk (d) In the air near the sun

Ans: (b) On the honeycomb

2. What does the angle of the straight run of the dance show?

(a) The distance of the flowers (b) The number of bees needed
(c) The direction of the flowers (d) The quality of honey

Ans: (c) The direction of the flowers

3. How do the other bees receive the message?

(a) By smelling the flowers
(b) By touching the dancer with their antennae
(c) By hearing a buzzing sound
(d) By following the queen

Ans: (b) By touching the dancer with their antennae

4. Which of the following best describes the main idea of the passage?

(a) Bees collect honey only in summer
(b) Honeybees share information through dance
(c) Bees are afraid of the sun
(d) The queen bee gives orders

Ans: (b) Honeybees share information through dance

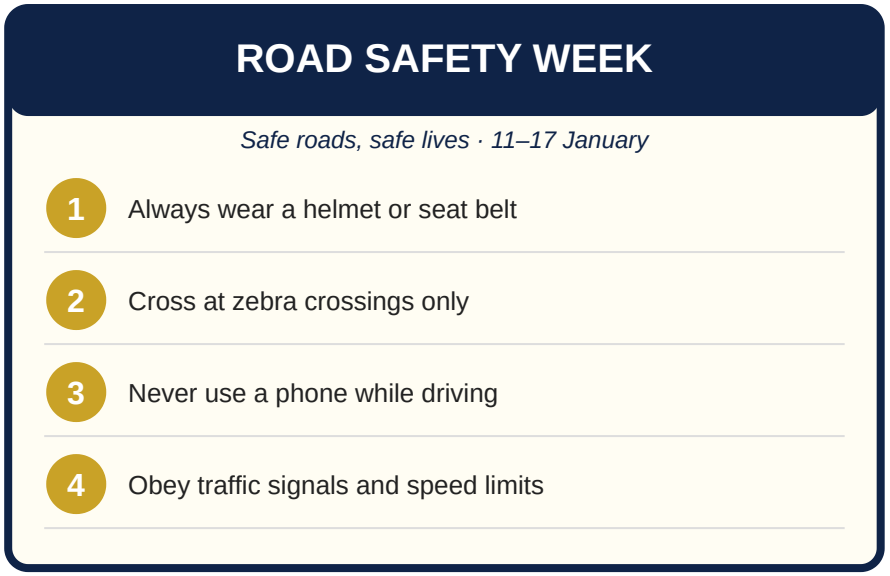
5. Why were the scientists 'amazed' when they decoded the bees' language? Answer in two points.

Ans: A creature with a very tiny brain / smaller than a sesame seed could share exact information about direction and distance (any two points, 1 mark each).

6. What does the time spent waggling tell the other bees?

Ans: How far they must fly to reach the flowers (distance).

Q2. Study the poster carefully and answer the questions that follow: **7**



Every year thousands of accidents on Indian roads are caused not by faulty vehicles but by careless human behaviour. Over-speeding, ignoring signals and the use of mobile phones while driving are leading causes. Children are especially at risk when they cross busy roads outside schools. The traffic police and schools organise a Road Safety Week every year to remind everyone that a few simple rules can save lives.

1) According to the passage, what causes many road accidents?

(a) Faulty vehicles (b) Careless human behaviour
(c) Bad weather (d) Narrow roads only

Ans: (b) Careless human behaviour

2) Which rule on the poster protects a pedestrian outside a school?

(a) Wear a helmet (b) Cross at zebra crossings only
(c) Never use a phone while driving (d) Obey the speed limit

Ans: (b) Cross at zebra crossings only

3) Rohan is about to ride his cycle on a main road. Which poster instruction should he follow?

(a) Cross at zebra crossings (b) Always wear a helmet
(c) Obey the school bell (d) Switch on the radio

Ans: (b) Always wear a helmet

4) Who is the poster mainly meant for?

(a) Only traffic policemen (b) All road users
(c) Only car drivers (d) Only children below five

Ans: (b) All road users

5) Why is it important to read the poster along with the passage? Give two reasons.

Ans: The passage explains why accidents happen; the poster tells what to do to avoid them; the poster is short and easy to remember (any two).

6) Why do schools organise Road Safety Week?

Ans: To remind everyone that simple rules can save lives.

SECTION B — GRAMMAR (14 Marks) — 14 marks

Q3. Do as directed.

I. Attempt any 4 from the following questions by choosing the most appropriate options. (4x1=4)

1) The teacher asked the students to _____ their phones before the exam.

(a) switch off (b) put on
(c) look after (d) take after

> **Ans:** (a) switch off

2) I could not _____ what he meant by that remark.

(a) make out (b) make up
(c) put away (d) turn down

> **Ans:** (a) make out

3) The plane will _____ at 6 a.m. tomorrow.

(a) take off (b) take after
(c) take up (d) take in

> **Ans:** (a) take off

4) She _____ her grandmother, as they both have the same smile.

(a) takes after (b) looks up
(c) gives away (d) puts off

> **Ans:** (a) takes after

5) We ran _____ of milk, so I went to the shop.

(a) out (b) off
(c) up (d) down

> **Ans:** (a) out

II. Attempt any 4 from the following questions as indicated against each one of them. (4x1=4)

6) Choose the correct preposition: The cat jumped _____ the table.

(a) onto (b) between
(c) among (d) beside

> **Ans:** (a) onto

7) She has lived in Jaipur _____ 2019.

(a) for (b) since
(c) from (d) during

> **Ans:** (b) since

8) The word 'quickly' in the sentence 'He ran quickly' is an adverb.
(State True or False.)

> **Ans:** True

9) Choose the correct word. The sun rises _____ the east. (in / on / at) *(in / on / at)*

> **Ans:** in

10) Identify the adverb in: *The old man walked slowly.*

(a) old (b) man
(c) walked (d) slowly

> **Ans:** (d) slowly

III. Attempt any 3 from the following questions as indicated against each one of them. **(3x1=3)**

11) Fill in the blank with the correct form of the verb. We _____ (visit) the fort last Sunday.

> **Ans:** visited

12) Choose the correct sentence.

(a) He go to school daily. (b) He goes to school daily.
(c) He going to school daily. (d) He gone to school daily.

> **Ans:** (b) He goes to school daily.

13) 'Has' is used with the pronoun 'they'.
(State True or False.)

> **Ans:** False

14) Choose the correct verb: She _____ a letter now.

(a) write (b) writes
(c) is writing (d) wrote

> **Ans:** (c) is writing

IV. Attempt any 3 from the following questions as indicated against each one of them. **(3x1=3)**

15) Choose the correct article: _____ honest man always speaks the truth.

(a) A (b) An
(c) The (d) No article

> **Ans:** (b) An

16) Fill in the blank with a, an or the. _____ moon moves round the earth.

> **Ans:** The

17) We use 'an' before a word that begins with a vowel sound.
(State True or False.)

> **Ans:** True

18) Choose the sentence with the correct use of articles.

(a) She bought a umbrella. (b) He is an university student.
(c) I saw an elephant at the zoo. (d) The Ganga are a long river.

> **Ans:** (c) I saw an elephant at the zoo.

SECTION C — WRITING (12 Marks) — 12 marks

Q4. Answer any one from A and B. **(1x6=6)**

(A) Draft a notice in about 50 words for your school notice board informing students of Classes VI–VIII about a Book Fair to be held in the school library from 15 to 17 December. You are Ravi/Ruchi, the Library Prefect.

> **Sample answer (about 50 words):**
> **GREEN VALLEY PUBLIC SCHOOL**
> **NOTICE** 5 December 2026
> **Book Fair**
> A Book Fair will be held in the school library from 15 to 17 December 2026, 9 a.m. to 2 p.m. Books on science, adventure and history will be available at attractive discounts. Students of Classes VI–VIII may visit during their library periods.
> Ravi, Library Prefect
> *Marking: Format 2; content (what, when, where, who) 3; language 1.*

O R

(B) Write a story-like account in 100–120 words of a day when you helped a stranger in need. Mention who needed help, what you did, how they reacted and what you felt.

Sample answer (100–120 words):
One rainy afternoon, on my way home from school, I saw an elderly man standing at the bus stop with a broken umbrella and a heavy bag. He looked lost. I walked up and asked if he needed help. He told me that he could not find the lane of his daughter's house. I took out my phone, checked the address with my mother's help and walked him to the lane. He blessed me and thanked me with tears in his eyes. I felt a warm happiness I had never felt before. That day I realised that a little kindness can change someone's whole day.
Marking: Content 3; organisation and fluency 2; accuracy 1.

Q5. Answer any one from A and B. **(1x6=6)**

(A) You are a resident of Vidyadhar Nagar, Jaipur. Write a letter to the Municipal Commissioner in 100–120 words about stray dogs causing fear among children in your colony. Request him to take suitable action.

Sample answer (100–120 words):
14 Vidyadhar Nagar
Jaipur
6 December 2026
The Municipal Commissioner
Jaipur Municipal Corporation
Subject: Menace of stray dogs in Vidyadhar Nagar
Sir,
I wish to bring to your notice the growing number of stray dogs in our colony. They move in packs, bark at night and chase children and cyclists. Two children were bitten last week and several parents are afraid to send their children to the park. I request you to send the animal birth control team to catch and vaccinate the dogs and to make sure waste is not left open, as it attracts them.
Yours faithfully
Vikas
Marking: Format 2; content 2; expression 2.

O R

(B) You are Sonal/Sohan. Write a letter to the Manager of 'Bright Music Academy', Jaipur in 100–120 words enquiring about guitar classes: batch timings, fees, duration of the course and availability of instruments.

Sample answer (100–120 words):
22 Civil Lines
Jaipur
6 December 2026
The Manager
Bright Music Academy
Jaipur
Subject: Enquiry about guitar classes
Sir,
I am a student of Class VIII and wish to learn the guitar. Kindly let me know the batch timings for beginners, preferably in the evening, and the monthly fee. Please also tell me the duration of the course, whether instruments are provided for practice and if there is a trial class. I shall be grateful for an early reply.
Yours faithfully
Sonal
Marking: Format 2; content (all four enquiries) 2; expression 2.

SECTION D — LITERATURE (20 Marks) — 20 marks

Q6. Read the following passage and answer any four out of the five questions that follow: **(4x1=4)**

Verghese Kurien, born in Kozhikode in 1921, is remembered as the father of India's White Revolution. He worked with milk farmers in Kaira district of Gujarat, who were cheated by middlemen and sold milk at very low rates. By helping them form a cooperative, he ensured that farmers got a fair price. This idea grew into the

brand Amul and later into Operation Flood, which made India one of the largest producers of milk in the world. Kurien insisted that the cooperative belonged to the farmers, not to any one individual.

a) Kurien is called the father of India's _____ Revolution. (White / Green) *(White / Green)*

> **Ans:** White

b) Farmers of Kaira district were cheated by middlemen.
(State True or False.)

> **Ans:** True

c) What did Kurien's cooperative ensure for farmers?
(a) Free cattle (b) A fair price for milk
(c) Foreign jobs (d) Cheaper fodder only

> **Ans:** (b) A fair price for milk

d) Kurien insisted that the cooperative belonged to:
(a) the government (b) the farmers
(c) the middlemen (d) foreign companies

> **Ans:** (b) the farmers

e) Why do you think the cooperative model succeeded?

> **Ans:** Farmers became owners, middlemen were removed, fair price was ensured, everybody benefited (any suitable reason).

Q7. Read the following extract and answer any two out of the three questions that follow: (2x2=4)

A little seed lay in the ground,
It slept without a sound;
The rain came down, the sun shone bright,
And it rose to greet the light.

a) Where did the little seed lie?

> **Ans:** In the ground (2)

b) Which two things helped the seed to grow?

> **Ans:** Rain and the sun (2)

c) Pick out a word from the extract that rhymes with 'ground'.

> **Ans:** sound (2)

Q8. Answer any four out of the five questions given below. (4x3=12)

a) What impact do you think the story of Major Somnath Sharma had on the young soldiers who heard about his bravery?

> **Ans:** It inspired courage, loyalty and sacrifice; showed leadership by example; made them proud of regiment and nation (any three).

b) 'I Too Had a Dream' shows that dreams need hard work. Explain with reference to Verghese Kurien.

> **Ans:** Kurien's dream of prosperous farmers was achieved through years of work with farmers, building a cooperative, facing opposition, patience and teamwork (any three).

c) Why is Tenali Ramakrishna considered a 'wit that won hearts'? Give three reasons.

> **Ans:** Humour, clever solutions to problems, honesty/courage in advising the king, kindness to the poor (any three).

d) What contrast does the poet show between the young people in the poem 'Somebody's Mother' and the old woman?

> **Ans:** Old woman waits alone and anxious at the crossing; boys are noisy, hurried and unconcerned; one boy shows kindness; contrast of youth and age, indifference and care (any three).

e) Compare the values shown by Major Somnath Sharma and Verghese Kurien in two points each (any one common value).

> **Ans:** Both showed dedication to the nation/people, selflessness and perseverance; Sharma through courage in battle, Kurien through service to farmers (3).